strong capabilities in the humanities and social sciences in Indian universities.

Summing up

Knowledge institutions shape the discourse. Complex reforms, such as the GST or inflation targeting, cannot be achieved as a palace coup; they require a shift in the entire discourse. Sustained work by large numbers of intellectuals in knowledge institutions is essential to achieving the new level of thinking.

Every policymaker will benefit by setting up a few knowledge partnership contracts, and take effort to make them work. In the short term, they are low-cost initiatives. In the long run, these will yield a qualitatively superior trajectory of the policy process.

This approach needs to be applied in all parts of government. Whether it is in Karnataka or in Shimoga, policymakers require capable knowledge institutions, which are steeped in the local context, and develop metis.

The intelligentsia in public policy is derived from the broad foundations of the humanities and social science knowledge that is made in the universities. In India, public investments in the universities have emphasized science and engineering and neglected the humanities and social sciences. Building the republic requires capabilities in the universities—in the humanities and the social sciences.